



▲ **1931** German engineers Max Knoll and Ernst Ruska invent the electron microscope, which can magnify objects up to an incredible 1 million times.

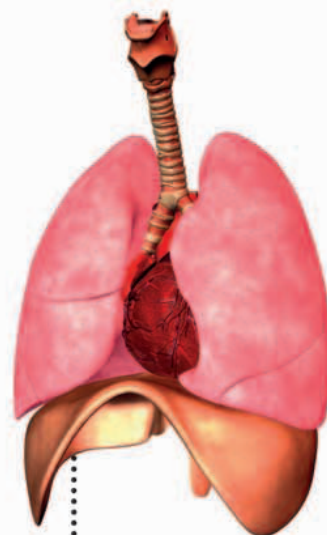
▼ **1955** Doctors start using ultrasound scanners to examine developing babies inside the womb.



1972 CT scanning is used for the first time to produce images of organs and tissues inside the body.



▲ **1978** On July 26, Louise Brown—the world's first test tube baby—is born in Britain. She was conceived by IVF nine months earlier in a laboratory.



▲ **2008** A Colombian woman has her damaged windpipe replaced by one custom-made using her own cells, reducing the risk of rejection by her body's defenses.



1930

1970

2000

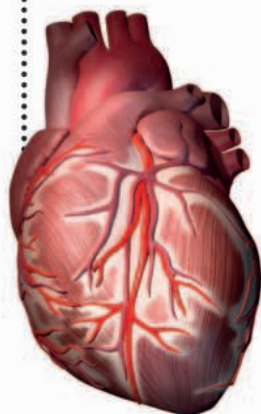
PRESENT

1954 The first successful kidney transplant—the transfer of a healthy kidney to a person with a diseased kidney—is performed in Boston.



▲ **1953** Scientists Francis Crick and James Watson discover the structure of DNA, the body chemical that carries genes.

▼ **1967** Surgeon Christiaan Barnard carries out the first heart transplant, in an operation lasting nine hours and involving a team of 30 people.



▼ **1980** Surgeons start using minimally invasive surgery to look inside the body and perform operations through tiny openings rather than large incisions.



1977 The killer infection smallpox becomes the first disease to be eradicated by a coordinated program of vaccination.

▼ **2003** Started in 1990, the Human Genome Project completes its goal of identifying the DNA sequence of a full set of human chromosomes, and shows that humans have about 23,000 genes.

